

WordPress Categories

Creating, assigning, editing, and deleting categories in WordPress

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1. What Are WordPress Categories?

WordPress Categories is an essential tool used by admins and users to divide a website's content into various sections. Categorisation based on genres and types tells readers about a post at a glance, so they can quickly find any post from the collection.

Categories are a convenient way to organise your written posts. Multiple subcategories allow for hierarchical arrangement, and a single post can belong to more than one category — giving both authors and readers maximum flexibility.

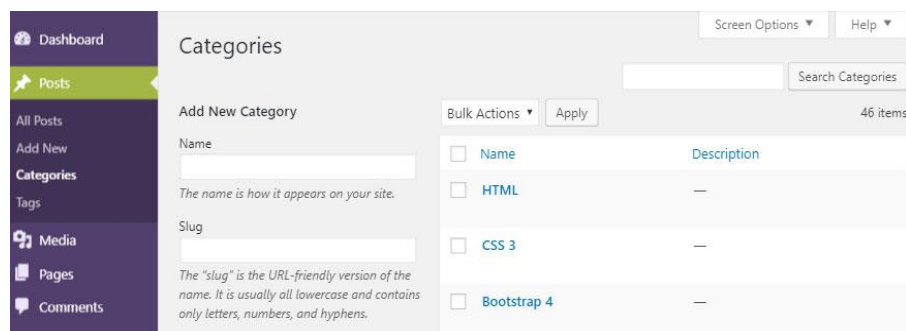
If no category is assigned to a post, WordPress sets it to 'Uncategorized' by default. Categories can appear in site widgets, menus, or directly in your WordPress theme. Subcategories allow you to build a multi-level hierarchy of content organisation. A single post can simultaneously belong to multiple categories.

2. How to Create Categories in WordPress?

Follow these steps to create a new category in WordPress:

- 1 Open Dashboard** — Log in and navigate to your WordPress Admin Dashboard.
- 2 Go to Categories** — Navigate to Posts > Categories in the Admin Sidebar Menu.
- 3 Fill in the Form** — Enter the category name and description in the left pane form.

4 Save — Click the "Add New Category" button to save and publish the category.



WordPress Admin — Posts > Categories — Add New Category form and category list

3. How to Assign Posts to Categories?

You can assign posts to categories as soon as your category structure is set up. There are two approaches:

- **While editing a post:** Open or create a post, then check the desired category in the Categories panel in the right-hand sidebar.
- **Multiple categories:** Check more than one category to assign a post to several sections simultaneously.

The Categories panel is found in the bottom-right of the post editor screen. You can create a new category directly from within the post editor. Most recently used categories appear at the top of the Categories panel.

4. Components of Adding Categories

When creating or editing a category, you will encounter these fields:

Field	Description
Name	A unique label for the category — this is what appears on your site and in menus.
Slug	The URL-friendly version of the name, used in the category's web address.
Parent	Optional — choose a parent to create a subcategory, or leave as 'None' for top-level.

Description
Optional — a brief summary about the category, which themes may display on archive pages.

The Slug is auto-generated from the Name but can be customised manually.
Parent categories allow you to create tree-style hierarchies (e.g., Tech > WordPress > Plugins).
Descriptions may appear on category archive pages depending on your active theme.

5. Editing and Deleting a Category

Editing a Category

Navigate to Posts > Categories in the Admin Sidebar. Hover your mouse over any category to reveal:

- **Edit:** Opens the full editor to update name, slug, parent, and description.
- **Quick Edit:** Inline editor for rapid changes to name and slug only.

Deleting a Category

Navigate to Posts > Categories, hover over the category, then click the Delete link that appears.

Deleting a category does NOT delete any posts assigned to it.
Posts in the deleted category automatically revert to 'Uncategorized'.
The default 'Uncategorized' category cannot be deleted from WordPress.